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1-INTRODUCTION

The alambamento is a traditional ceremony in Angolan culture that it usually happens when young people fall in love and intend to live together. It is the second step after the presentation of the groom to the bride's family, being the moment when the dowry required by the future wife's family is delivered, accompanied by food, drink, music, and advice from both parties addressed to the bride and groom.

Marriage is the voluntary union between two people who wish establish a family, forming a marital bond that is based on the conditions provided by civil law.

2.1- THE WIRING

In Luanda, the alambamento or the request (for the bride's hand) is still a quite strong cultural tradition, and according to what is said, it is more important than the civil or 'religious' marriage. According to Agostinho (2011), the term winding, since the early days of colonization until today, has been used erroneously by many authors. Maia (1994 apud AGOSTINHO, 2011), in his complementary dictionary of Portuguese Kimbundu and Kikongo assigns to the term synonym of 'dowry', which would be equivalent to the 'bride price'. The cited author the term 'alambamento' fits in the 'A' list of Portuguese words and the term 'marriage' fits in the list 'c' (of words in the Portuguese language, as a synonym of kulemga/ou kulemba, from which the term alambamento derives. According to the author, this contradiction is distinguished by the consequence. etymological and conceptual 'grave'. Augustine (2011), in turn, says that Etymologically, the word 'alambamento' derives from the Kimbundu language 'kulemba'. what it means to pay tribute to the future father-in-law through gifts conventional. The cabling derives directly from this verb, after replace the radical of infinity 'Ku' due to the influence of Portuguese.

In Angola, the alambamento or request (for the bride's hand) is still a very strong cultural tradition and reportedly more important than the civil or religious marriage. The alambamento consists of a series of rituals, such as the delivery of a letter requesting the bride's hand, offers in goods and sometimes even money.

When the young couple of lovers decides to marry, it is necessary to have the this is only possible if, during the proposal, everyone agreeing that the marriage will materialize. The young couple sets the wedding request day. This day is marked by the bride's uncles, as it is necessary to gather the whole family is given a list containing what the groom has to achieve gather until the day of the request.

The list includes various consumer items and although they are normally the same for everyone, may vary according to the family in question.

The day of the request is set and the groom sets off in search of everything material so that nothing is missing on the day. And what is on this list? First is an envelope with money. 300, 400, 500 USD, depending on what the uncle stipulates. The bride's height in beer cans, the bride's height in juice pallets or coca-cola, a goat, a suit for the uncle and some shoes for the mother.

also make a description of the lamination with reference to importance of the list delivered to the groom: It is a list prepared by the guys, where there is a list of things that the groom has to "buy" for

to offer to the bride's family, as compensation for the expenses incurred with her from birth until the day of the wedding. Basically, it is a dowry that represents a valuable asset because the higher the payment, the greater the prestige the bride will have.

If the bride is pregnant, the amounts referred to above increase a lot.

This value may still be higher if the groom has jumped out the window. Jumping the window means that the bride got pregnant before the wedding and of course, it is just that the order should be reinforced. When the day of the order arrives, the family members the groom joins the bride's family, introductions are made and proceed to the marriage proposal.

Here is how the process is carried out, according to Angolan culture: When the day arrives, the groom's family (father, mother, uncle, aunt, siblings) goes to the house of the bride and her uncle, as if he were a judge, present everything people and inform that the marriage proposal will begin. The parents of the bride invites the groom's parents to enter and the uncle begins the reading of the request presented by the groom. If the bride's father agrees to the request, the groom you will have to go get the wiring, that is, that list of things you gathered. the wrap-up is presented and if everything is fulfilled a meeting is held to to finalize the wedding date and other logistical details. That being said, one sings and one dances (it's no coincidence that beer crates appear and coca-cola on the list).

Starting from this day, if all goes well, the couple of lovers begins to husband and wife. When it comes to the wedding, some couples tie the knot dressed up in traditional clothes while others prefer to wear the famous suit and tie and the brides the traditional white dress.

On the wedding day, the woman dresses in a suit, a typical outfit of country, and the man dresses in a dress shirt, suit, and tie. Before the bride appears under a cloth, to test if the husband loves her recognizes for real.

After the union is properly formalized, it's time for the party or not Angolans are celebrators by nature. Food and drink in abundance. delight the guests, always accompanied by good music from earth

As tradition is no longer what it used to be and despite the embellishment still being a strong characteristic of Angolan culture, the truth is that this habit will falling into disuse. Along with modernity, and not just in Angola, some families abandon this tradition while conservative ones make a point of it

to maintain. At the same time, Angolan society recognizes the importance perform the ritual of alambamento.

2.1.1 - COLONIAL IDEOLOGY AND THE NOTION OF ALAMBAMENTO

The aim of Portuguese colonialism since its arrival was to alienate the African populations in ways to convert them to Christianity and consequently explore them culturally under the banner of "civilization."

For the colonizer, "civilization" should be Portuguese, with the rest two ethnic groups of Angola within this rule. The objective of the ideology Portuguese colonialism in relation to Bantu marriage (Alambamento) was reduce it to the parameters of civil (Western) and Christian marriage, in order to inverting the true meaning of this institution, seeing it only as a deed of purchase and sale of the woman, in other words, a complete lack of consideration and respect for the culture of the native.

According to Mbambi (1997, p. 1), Father Francisco Valente, after having studied the Alambamento in Huambo and surrounding areas, to what extent it can be done, condemned in his book, written on the subject, as an embarrassing habit of the the inequality of African women and that it should be abolished.

Therefore, these explanations about the distillation are very distant. to correspond to the truth and to enter into the true breadth of marriage Bantu, particularly in the province of Luanda. This information is the result of Portuguese colonial ideology of domination, to better dominate the populations, in partnership with the Catholic religion, which has always been during the time of the Portuguese colonial occupation, they had the objective of to distort the true meaning and purpose of the institution of the enlargement and replace the European-centered ideologies of yours (civil marriage).

Agostinho (2011) states that colonial ideology, in the social field, for In addition to boosting the crisis of cultural values, it divided Angolans into two. social classes: 'assimilated' and 'indigenous'. Among them, the loss of cultural values would affect more the "assimilated" class, due to contact direct and almost always permanent with the colonizer, the "assimilated" they sought to guide their conduct according to the standards of culture Portuguese. According to Kamabaya (2003 apud Agostinho 2011), in 1950 the statistics from the famous assimilation showed that the number of natives assimilated was so small that only 1% of the entire population of Angola at that time what era was assimilated

2.1.2-CHANGE IN BANTU MARRIAGE RULES AND THE LOSS OF YOUR SYMBOLIC VALUE SINCE THE COLONIAL ERA

According to Agostinho (2011), several changes emerged in Luanda. rules of Bantu marriage during the period of Portuguese colonization (1951 to

1970), among them stand out the following: the loss of the value of virginity, the addition of the wine jug, the replacement of the figure of the emissaries (intermediaries) by a simple letter of request, the disappearance of temporary matrilineal resistance and the annulment of the rite of passage called "mussula", which marks a woman's entry into the status of mother. Monteiro, for his part, says that:

Luanda, like in other urban environments, the old relationships, which made this alliance a balance of mutual interest without great concerns for individual feelings, approaches or disappears. The marriage takes a more individual than social, consent matrimonial becomes more authentic and personal for nubent, but all of this moves away from the characteristics of extended family. That is why it has been said, somewhat frequently, especially among elderly people, who currently our music counts but the opinion and taste of the children, marriage matters, rather than the interests of the parents. (MONTEIRO, 1973, p.117- 182).

In the past, virginity was something of great importance, and it was very preserved by the bride's family, after entering into marriage, there was a sample in public, with a handkerchief containing blood, showing how much the girl was well brought up by her parents and is pure, but currently she is already practicing it is not felt in the heart of Luandan society. In the Luanda area, according to Ribas (2006), this brand inspired certain care. In the past, the young women were subjected to frequent searches, either simply by eye, or with a dove's egg, you want with the tip of a candle, previously devoid of the external part of the wick. So only the wiring process was carried out. when everything went well.

The emissary that used to be the intermediary of the distillation has been replaced by the letter of request, which is still in effect in the institution of twisting. For this reason, the elders are no longer respected as in the past, in fact, this issue has a lot to do with acculturation through the assimilation of culture conveyed through the media of mass.

Due to colonial influence and, consequently, Western culture, the the alambamento ritual has lost strength, as many families no longer they practice for the forces of such 'civilization' or even out of shame and thinking outdated. In short, because of colonial influence, the people of the province from Luanda, began to observe traditional marriage as a practice without cultural expression, something that is worthless to contemporary society. According to Agostinho (2011), these ideologies constituted a negative mark.

at the level of collective consciousness, so that, despite the Ambundu of Luanda will continue to emphasize traditional marriage. treat it as an unfinished product and to complete it [and/or finalize it] they believed they should also marry according to the rules of civil marriage and Christian. (AUGUSTINE, 2011).

Nowadays, the population of Luanda in general does not look at the twisting like a wedding that symbolizes national culture, very much by On the contrary, the view of this cultural ceremony is a Eurocentric perspective, made with disdain and almost without interest. The practice of stretching still has persisted a little within society, because there are certain families conservatives who still operate within the confines of marriage traditional (distillation). Therefore, it is quite important to recover the values of cultural traditions among young people so that they begin to have a positive outlook on the issue of widening, since they are the driving force of society, and it is up to them to continue the cultures that They exist within society, in ways that do not disappear.

2.2- MARRIAGE

The civil marriage is a contract between two people traditionally. with the aim of starting a family. The exact definition varies historically and among cultures, but until recently and in most of countries, it was a socially sanctioned union between a man and a woman (with or without children) under community of life and property. Until the 19th century, the marriage was seen in Western societies merely as an agreement commercial between two families without the two parties having much vote on the subject. Romanticism came to change this image and then it became the concept of marrying for love exists.

Until the 20th century, it was common for marriage to be seen as something indissoluble (although it could be annulled), with no legal recognition of divorce. When referring to the celebration of a ceremony in a church and to the recognition of the union by the religious community is called marriage religious or marriage. The Catholic Church does not recognize divorce nor civil marriages held after this, prohibiting access to communion to those who are in this situation.

The people who married each other are commonly called spouses, identified as husband and wife, or spouse and spouse.

Legally, the main influence of marriage is on the situation of assets. the spouses, who will receive differentiated treatment according to the regime of adopted by the couple. Regardless of the property regime, the marriage

civil has an impact on other areas as well, such as inheritance, obligation to support and responsibilities towards children.

2.2.1 - MARRIAGE IN THE WORLD

In most Western countries, the rules of civil and religious marriage they are different: the state defines the civil rules and each religion defines its own rules of the religious. Not violating the principle of separation between state and religion, most states have specific laws that allow validity automatic of religious marriage (normally only of the dominant religion in the country) for civil purposes. There are other states where civil marriage (just like divorce) is inseparable from religious marriage.

In terms of children, according to Eurostat data from 2003, the civil marriage is not seen in Europe as the only way to regulate a relationship with children: the average of the 25 countries analyzed was 32% of children outside of civil marriage. At the top of the table, Estonia appears with 58% and the Sweden with 55% of births outside of civil marriage. Other countries like Finland, United Kingdom, Slovenia, Latvia, France, and Denmark have values between 40% and 50%, Portugal is slightly below the European average with 29%, while at the other end, we have Italy with 15%, Greece with 5% and Cyprus with 3%.

According to the same data, 67% of European households do not have children, including 29% of single-person households, 24% of households with couples without children and 14% of households with only adults in another type of relationship. Of the households with children, 13% have only one parent.

2.2.2- MARRIAGE IN THE CURRENT SOCIETY OF LUANDA

Marriage symbolizes respect and continuity for the Bantu people. marriage is also the meeting with our ancestors through the formation of a new family to make up society.

Altuna (1985) asserts that marriage contains a heavy symbolism of significant efficacy and achieves the perpetuity and expansion of the life of all family, and it is a bond that translates one family into another.

However, currently marriage no longer represents its true symbolism, in fact, traditional marriage has lost strength over the years time, in relation to European marriage (registry office and Catholic religion). Agostinho (2011) states that in order to frame the strutting in society It is necessary, first and foremost, to know how the are organized families in Luanda. For the author emphasizes that:

(...) in Luanda, the extended family type still predominates and that the difficulties of these families are increasing due to long period of civil war that the country experienced from 1992 to 2002. This same war generated extreme poverty with a large tendency to singularize itself. Nowadays, young people no longer they recognize the uncles (maternal), as someone who has a cultural power over them, and currently the visits that were made occasionally for the purpose of knowing if the family was together health goods are no longer made.
13).

Oppenheimer and Raposo (2007) affirm that there are many factors that they made this change happen in the organization of the family, these factors driven by the destabilization war that ravaged the country, and consequently the degradation of social structures that drove the development of society, just like official schools, Westernized.

This situation of precariousness, combined with an insufficient school network and professional training, the transformation of traditional social ties in the environment urban, generates a feeling of individual insecurity and social disintegration, favorable to the development of activities labeled as deviant or criminal activities that mainly attract street children or youth in a state of delinquency.

In short, what lies at the heart of the cultural crisis within society Luandense is the lack of adequate social infrastructures that improve the quality of life of the Luandense populations, and as a result of that the families face many problems in transmitting knowledge traditional Bantu wedding customs for the new generation.

2.3 - SOCIETY'S VIEW ON COUPLES LIVING TOGETHER MARRIED WITHOUT THE PRACTICE OF WEDLOCK

Families living together without the practice of cohabitation do not are respected in society. In the past, for a couple to live together had to do the bonding, as this practice legitimizes the couple, the children that The rights arising from this marriage are respected and recognized by society. But currently this practice is no longer observed, as many young people come together. without making the widening, claiming that this is an outdated practice. From according to Agostinho (2011):

The legitimization establishes the children, putting in place the legal title. Luanda still retains the ancestral sense in most of the ethnic groups, a large number of unions is observed marriages conceived without the Alambamento. The reasons that are

based on this phenomenon is the cultural crisis that started in the period colonial, which culminated in the civil war, (ended in 2002), giving rise to extreme poverty within Luandan families. (AGOSTINHO, 2011, p. 18).

It should be emphasized that a considerable number of young people in Luanda do not the request due to lack of financial condition, and others do not do it because they think that the the practice of alambamento is already outdated, looking at it as a ritual of populations living in the countryside. In this way, many families they stop doing the wiring, and consequently he has been losing his national level force.

O alambamento é uma prática cultural muito importante para a nossa sociedade, é através dela que novas famílias se formam para compor a society, and essential values are transmitted within it for the functioning of our society, it is necessary to create mechanisms that ensure the appreciation and protection of the wiring so that it does not in the future come to disappear, for a society without its own culture and identity is a society without direction for the future.

According to Onofre (2010), the tradition has changed, nowadays, even though it is of great importance to society it has been left behind. All these issues of value loss in the cabling are related to modernity. Currently, there is another motivation for life, people are more concerned with living their lives according to the canons of the 26th West, not looking at our cultural values with that motivation that it leverages the recovery of our values. Therefore, it is necessary understanding that modernity affected the wiring in Luanda, and not only that, it has a lot to do in part with the emergence of industrialization (implementation of large multinational companies), of urbanization, of appearance of the bureaucratic state, among others. In a way, all these the issues of modernity mentioned above are at the heart of change thoughts that affect society and the consequent trivialization of local cultural traditions.

3-CONCLUSION

This work was done with dedication and we believe it has fulfilled the expectations. In achieving it, we learned that the strapping or request it is even considered a more important event than a civil marriage or religious and consists of asking the girlfriend's family for her hand, more precisely to the uncle, who plays a fundamental role in making the marriage happen. The role of uncles is as important or more important than that of parents, because uncles are also responsible for the education of the bride.

The modernization and evolution of society can be considered as the main responsible for the loss of the symbolic value of the shambling within Luandan society. Most families nowadays no longer one cares about the symbolic value of the gauging.

Currently, there is a lot of discussion in Luanda about true functions. of alliance as 'alliance' between families and as legitimization of relationships intimate and transmission of traditional knowledge in the face of 'modernism'.

On the other hand, we were interested in bringing to Angolan society a approach to the essential aspects of Alambamento, to rescue its function and its framing as a culturally significant aspect in Angolan society.

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